



PHOTO BY **BANDEEP SINGH**



RIL Chairman &
Managing Director
Mukesh Ambani



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UNORGANISED CATEGORIES"

A Push For Self-Reliance

Reliance Industries is putting manufacturing at the centre of its next phase, from new energy and batteries to retail, consumer products and garments

BY **KRISHNA GOPALAN**



THINK RELIANCE AND what comes to mind most often is large-scale manufacturing. From its early phase in textiles to its eventual move into petrochemicals and oil refining, the story has only become bigger. Today, with multiple businesses, Reliance is thinking even bigger on manufacturing. Be it new energy, retail or oil refining, manufacturing is at the centre of the story.

When Mukesh Ambani, Reliance's Chairman & Managing Director, addressed shareholders earlier this year, he took some time to outline why the current moment is challenging. The most important lesson for India from these volatile times, he said, is that we must intensify and speed up our efforts "to make our country *atmanirbhar* in critical resources and technologies".

Maximum energy self-sufficiency and AI self-sufficiency must become national missions, he said. "The success of these missions is crucial to the success of Viksit Bharat." Importantly, he stated that Reliance is playing a leading role in both national imperatives. "We have laid the foundation for Reliance to emerge as a leading deep-tech and advanced manufacturing company. For this, we are investing an extraordinary amount on innovation and R&D efforts," he said.

In many ways, this is an affirmation of how manufacturing is being viewed within Reliance, which has moved from being a B2B behemoth to a major B2C player as well; the latter includes digital, retail and financial services. The common thread, unsurprisingly, is manufacturing.

New energy, he stated, was Reliance's most ambitious generational undertaking, designed to solve "India's energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability simultaneously, and at a scale, that has no parallel".

Last fiscal, the solar PV cell and module manufacturing lines were commissioned. During FY27, the first phase of the battery energy storage system and cell giga factory is on track to be commissioned.

Under Reliance Retail and Reliance Consumer Products, a manufacturing platform is being built. "This will extend from beverages and daily essentials to one of the most unorganised categories," he said.

The company is also partnering with Rolls-Royce to develop and manufacture an engine for India's fighter jet programme. **BT**

@krishnagopalan